comes off big, but he doesn't always come off. Thank goodness. The chances of Warner ever being picked for a Test team – or even wanting to play Test cricket – are slim. Why would he? The guy is travelling the world playing really exciting cricket, having the time of his life and earning a ton of money – more than he would have earned in Test cricket, certainly. The same applies to guys like Kieron Pollard of the West Indies and India's Yusuf Pathan – you don't hear their names mentioned in Test cricket.

I do understand it, though – why would you want to play Test cricket when you've got money coming at you left, right and centre for just 20/20 cricket? Pollard (along with Kiwi Shane Bond) was sold for the player-cap maximum of US$750 000 at the last Indian Premier League player auction in January 2009. And young South African fast bowler Wayne Parnell went for US$610 000.

Those sums make these youngsters instant millionaires. And remember, that's not the total fee for their three-year contract – it's what they get *per year* for three years. Who needs to play Test cricket if you are earning that kind of cash for six weeks' work per year? Now add a county contract, plus your own domestic-franchise contract, and you are smiling, boet.

You have to remember, though, that the only reason 20-over cricket has so much cash at its disposal is because fans want to go and watch the games. Take the IPL, for example – easily the most successful tournament currently out there. In fact, it's one of the most successful tournaments in world sport as far as spectator attendance is concerned – reports state that IPL 3 attracted more eyeballs than any other sports tournament in history.

The popularity of the game is reflected in the amounts that the two new franchises – Pune and Kochi – were sold for in March 2010. At US$370 million for Pune and US$333.33 million for Kochi, that is three times more than the original franchises were sold for just three years earlier. I mean, that is phenomenal growth! Even within the increasing popularity of 20-over cricket, nothing compares to the IPL as far as the vibe of the tournament goes. The T20 World Cup doesn't even come close to the razzmatazz and heightened feeling of excitement that spectators, players and the organisers experience with the IPL.

Not only has 20-over cricket changed the format of the game; it's also having an impact on the design of the equipment. Matthew Hayden's revolutionary Mongoose bat got a lot of attention at IPL 3. With a handle that is 43 per cent longer and a blade 33 per cent shorter but thicker than a